4.7 WRITING LESSONS 10–11

OVERVIEW

Duration: 40+40 minutes

Objectives:
- Can understand short, simple messages on postcards, emails and social networks (GSE 31 – A2).
- Can write short, basic descriptions of places, people or things (GSE 38 – A2+).

Resources:
- SB p. 56
- WB p. 56
- Online resources: Teacher's Resources, Sample answer for Exercise 7

LESSON 10

WARM-UP | 5 minutes

(T–S, S–T) Activate Ss' interest in the topic. Ask: *What is a blog? How is a blog different from a website? What kinds of subjects do bloggers write about? What kind of blogs interest you? How do you start your own blog?* Elicit ideas from different Ss and have a brief class discussion.

PRACTICE | 32–34 minutes

1 (S–T, T–S) Refer Ss to Exercise 1. Read through the topics with the class and give Ss 30 seconds to choose three of them that are needed to describe oneself. Then elicit answers from different Ss and check.

2 (S–S, S–T, T–S) Ss do Exercise 2 individually. Give them 2 minutes and then 1 extra minute to check their answers in pairs before doing a class check. Then ask a few general comprehension questions like: *How old is she? What does she look like? What is she like? Why is she writing this blog? Does she have any sisters or brothers? What is her brother like? What is her sister like?*

3 (S–S, S–T, T–S) Ss do Exercise 3 individually. Give them 2 minutes to complete the table about Emily. Do a class check. Then give Ss 2 extra minutes to complete the table about Tiago. When they have finished, elicit ideas and have a brief class discussion.

4 (S–S, S–T, T–S) Refer Ss to Exercise 4. Give them 2 minutes to complete the WRITING FOCUS with examples from Emily's profile and then 1 extra minute to check their answers in pairs before doing a class check. Go through the WRITING FOCUS with the class and check Ss understand parts of a personal profile and what to write in each part. Wherever possible, suggest alternative examples and elicit examples from Ss for each part.

5 (S–S, S–T, T–S) Ss do Exercise 5 individually. Give them 2 minutes and then 1 extra minute to check their answers in pairs before doing a class check. Elicit from Ss what adverbs are used and what their position in a sentence should be. Optionally, this could be done as an oral drill. Ask Ss to change the sentences to be true for them and read out their sentences.

6 (S–S, S–T, T–S) Ss do Exercise 6 individually. Give them 2 minutes and then 1 extra minute to check their answers in pairs before doing a class check. Elicit from Ss which adjectives are used in which order. Optionally, this could be done as an oral drill. Ask Ss to change the sentences to be true for them and read out their sentences.

LESSON 11

PRODUCTION | 38 minutes

1 (S–S) Refer Ss to Exercise 7. Give Ss 20–25 minutes to look at the table they have completed for Tiago in Exercise 3 and write about him and his family. Remind Ss to use the WRITING FOCUS to help them. Also, tell them that they can use Emily's post as a model for their writing. As they do this, walk around monitoring, supporting and taking notes of any problems.

2 (S–S) When they have finished writing, tell Ss to self-check their posts. Optionally, to help Ss with this, prepare a checklist beforehand and give a copy of it to each S in the class. You can write questions similar to the following on the list: *Have you used all of the information in the table? Have you used phrases from the WRITING FOCUS? Have you divided the profile into paragraphs? Have you checked your grammar and spelling?* Explain to Ss that they need to tick each item on the checklist to show that they have checked their piece of writing for that item. Monitor and support as they do this.

3 (S–S) Then put Ss in pairs and tell them to swap their posts. Ss should now check if their partner's post includes all the information and if everything is clear and then they give it back.

TIP

Ss can edit each other's work again using the checklist you gave to them.

4 (S–S) Give Ss another 5 minutes to rewrite their work before handing it in for your evaluation and feedback. Finally, do a class feedback session.

5 (T–S, S–T) Give Ss a model text for Exercise 7 and ask them to compare it with their own. Optionally, this could be omitted or could be done in a following lesson if you are short of time.

HOMEWORK

1 Give Ss WB p. 56 as homework.

2 Ask Ss to study the Word list on p. 57.

CONTINGENCY PLAN

1 Refer to TB p. 56 for extra activities.

2 Refer to TB p. 57 for Word list activities.